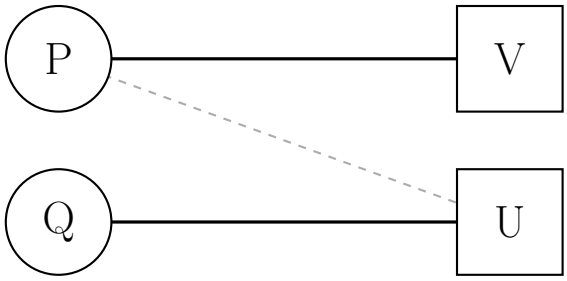
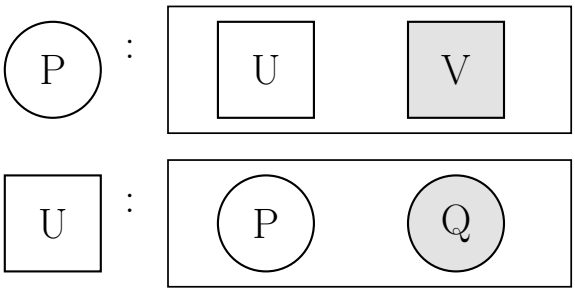
Pair each circle with one square, using every letter once. Each strip runs from first choice to last. A pairing can stay if no two letters in different pairs both prefer each other to their current partners.

Example: check P with U. First choice is on the left.

Current pairs



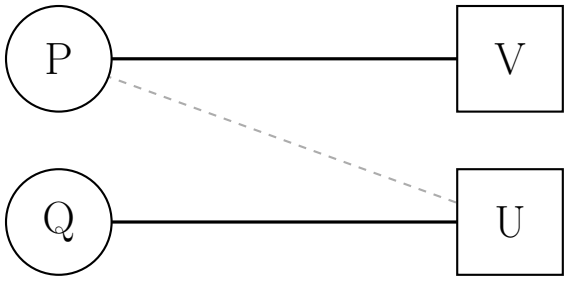


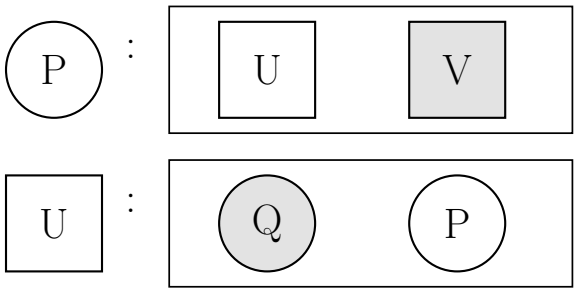
P prefers U to V: yes

U prefers P to Q: yes

Both yes: P and U block.

Current pairs





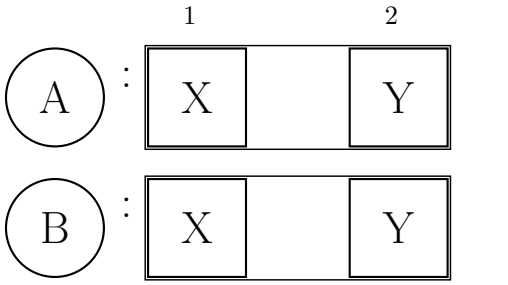
P prefers U to V: yes

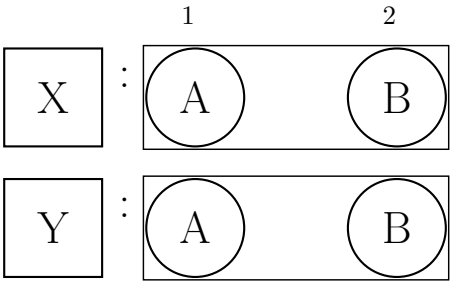
U prefers P to Q: no

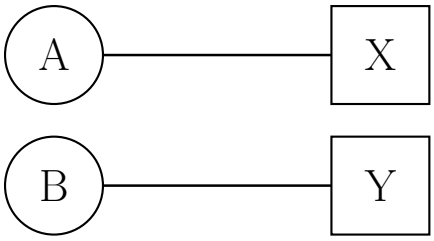
P and U do not block.

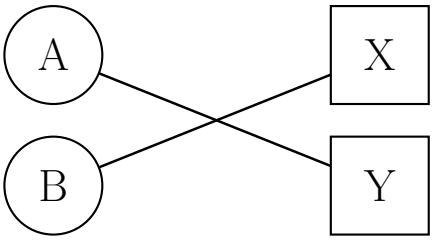
Shaded choice = current partner. This check is only for P and U.

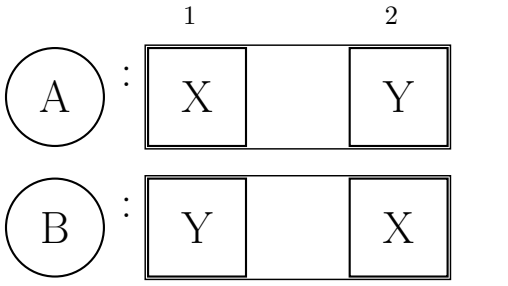
Problem 1: Circle every pairing that can stay. On each other pairing, join a circle and a square that would both rather be together.

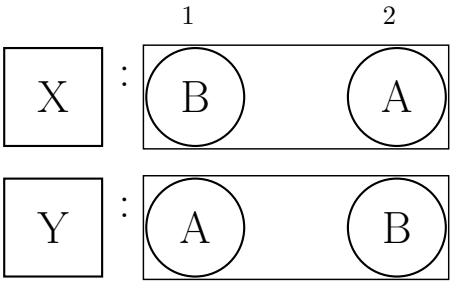


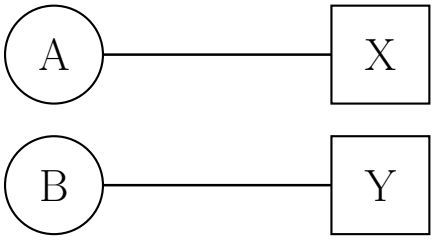


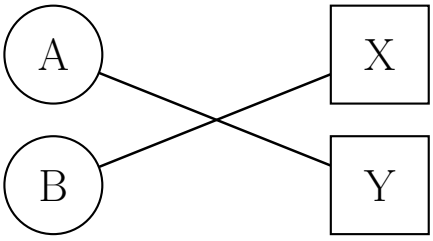




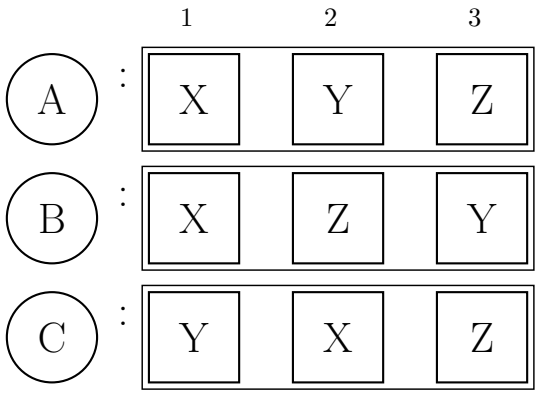


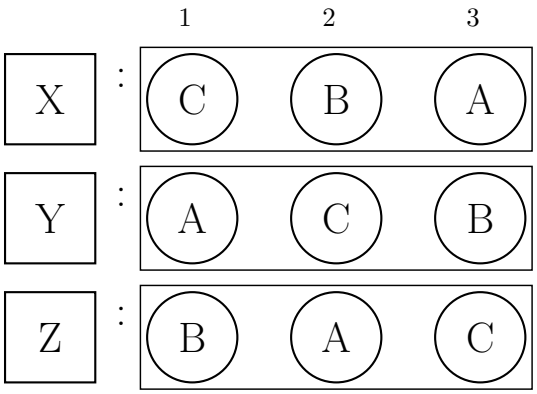


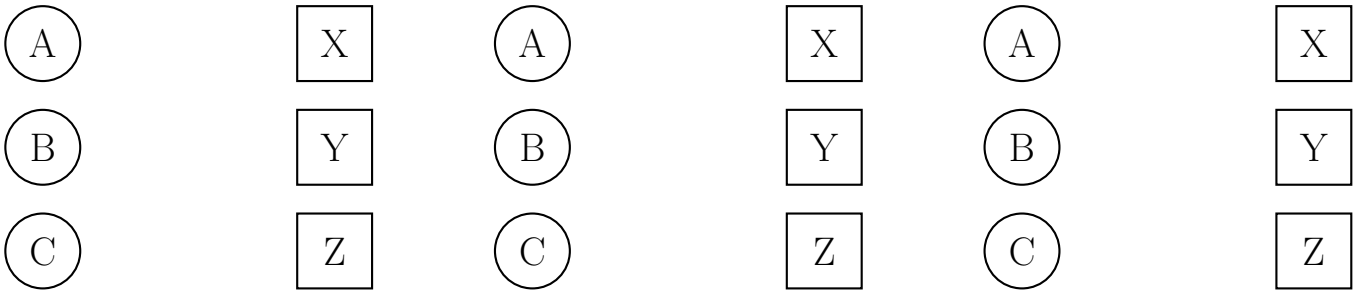


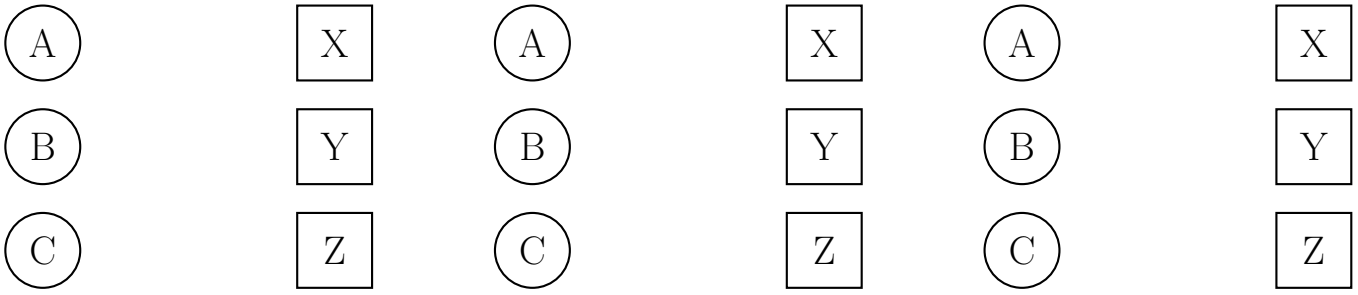


Problem 2: Find every pairing that can stay.

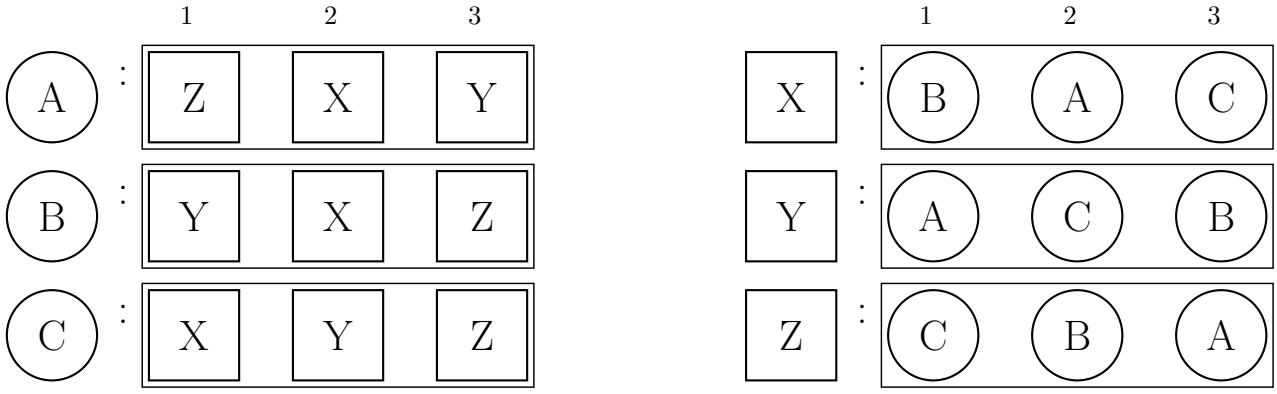


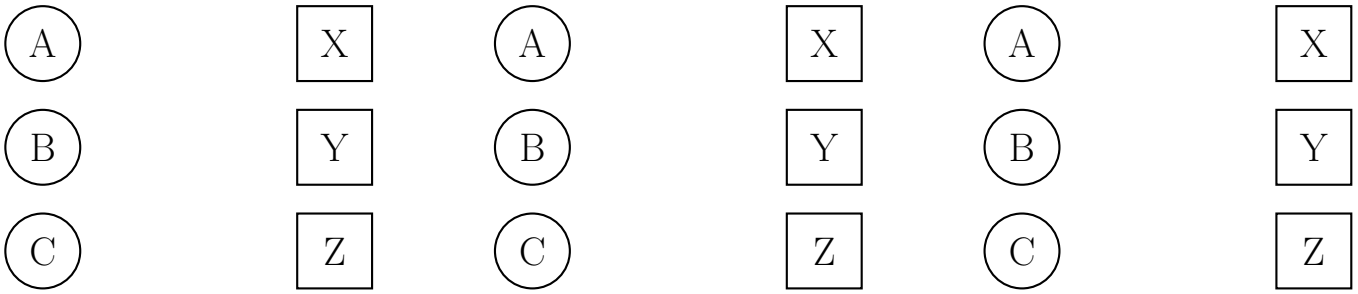


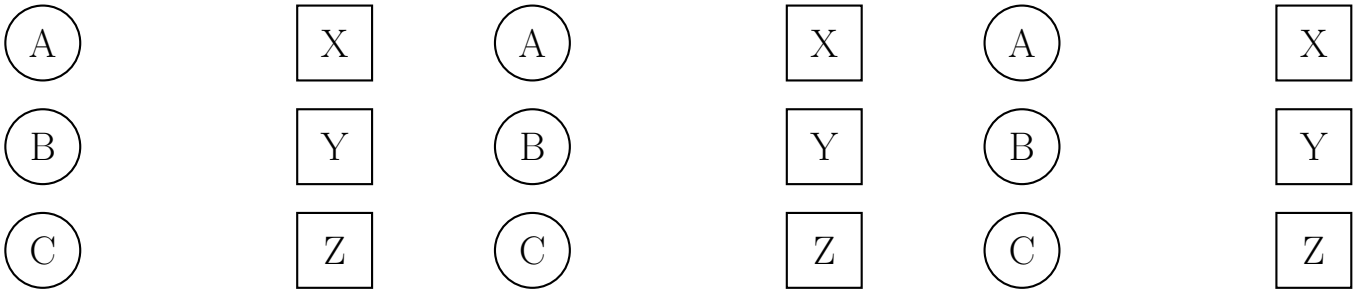




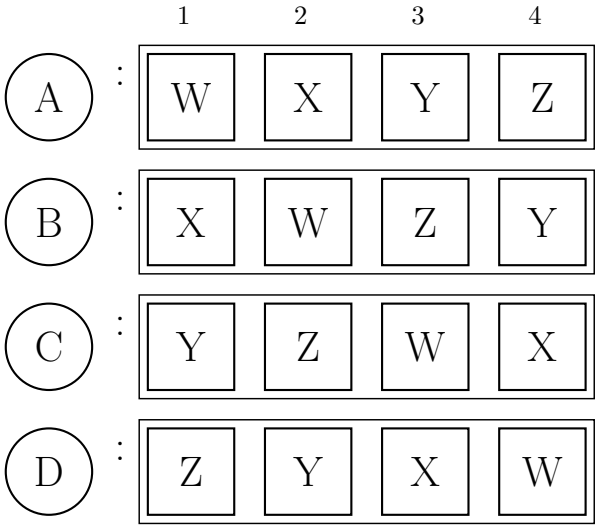
Problem 3: Find every pairing that can stay. How do you know your list is complete?

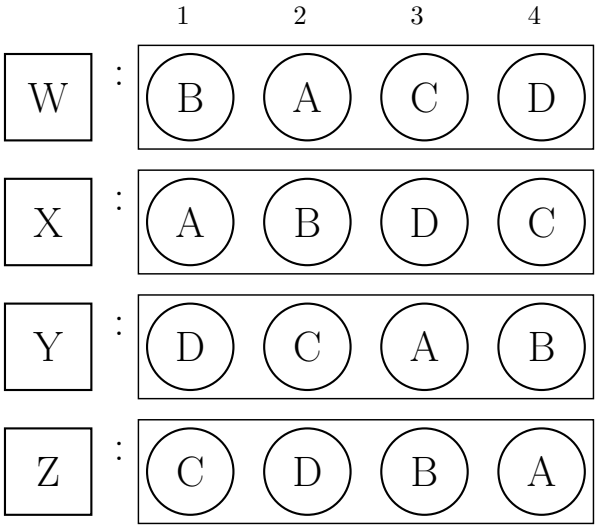


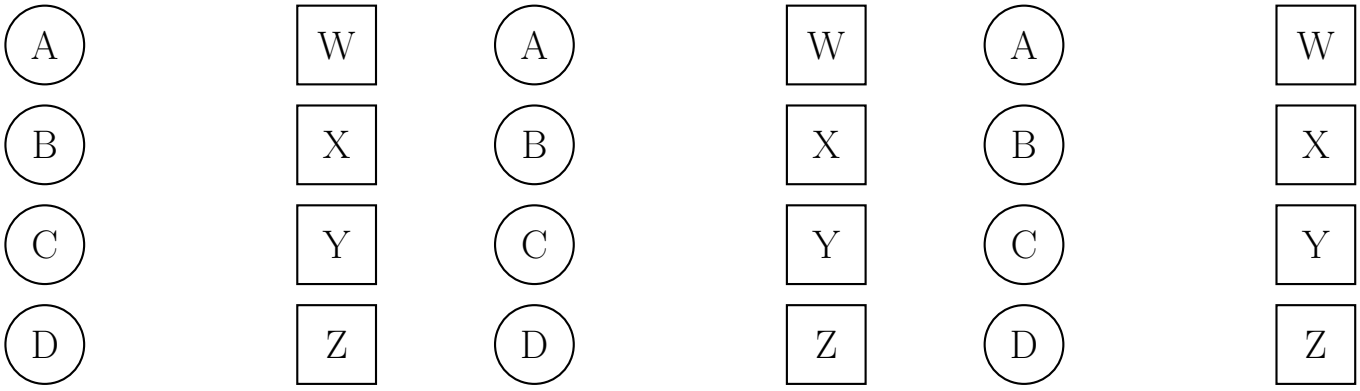


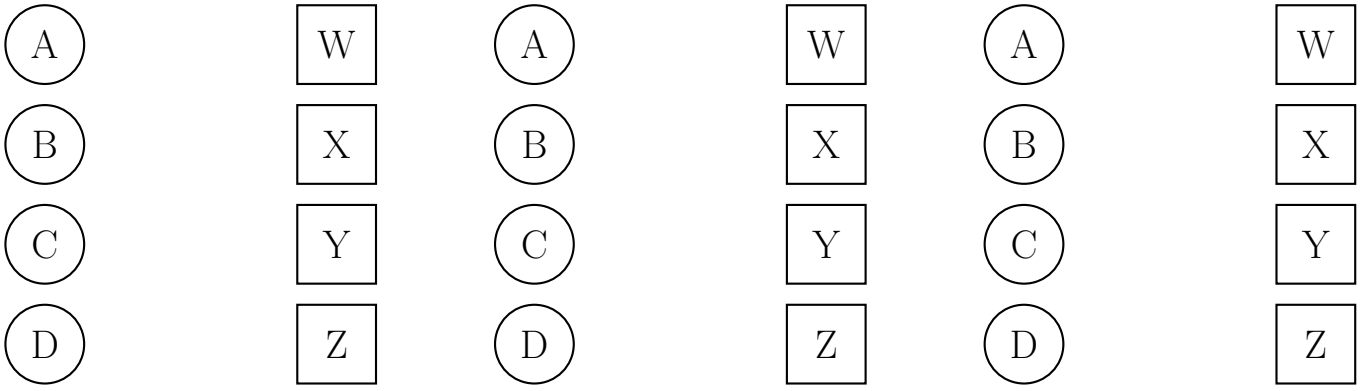


Problem 4: Find every pairing that can stay. Can one pairing give all eight letters their first choice?









Problem 5: Put X, Y, Z in each circle's strip and A, B, C in each square's strip, in any order. Make exactly two pairings that can stay. Explain why every other pairing fails.

